

Drink From the Well of Worship

When I first went to Immokalee, Florida, I remembered the pastor's real name. But after they told me his nickname was Bronk, I could not remember his real name anymore. I just know Bronk.

Bronk, would you come up here for just a minute? Hallelujah.

I have some special instructions for this morning, and He wants me to spend a little time at this point on worship.

I can remember at the March conference that sometime just before that, God was introducing me to worship by telling me I did not know much about it. That is how you can get a prideful preacher into anything. It is all right to have pride if it only exists before God, because He can kill it.

But when He set me on fire with worship, I went around with the initial revelation. Bronk picked up on it, and he can tell you the fight he had with his flesh while breaking into it.

One reason I am having him testify for a few moments is because one of his favorite phrases in Immokalee became, "Another notable miracle." He told me about the woman in the wheelchair who had seven or eight disintegrated vertebrae, and she walked out of the wheelchair that night. He said she is still walking into the church. He told me about the woman with the paralyzed arm, and the blind boy who was healed in that crusade.

Needless to say, Bronk was breaking into worship sometime just before that. He was able to tell me some of the wars he fought, and I understood them thoroughly.

The reason I am getting him to testify is that three or four notable miracles just happened in his ministry, not in an atmosphere charged with power, but as he tracked people down among unbelievers and got them healed.

This is becoming common here. There are other testimonies from Utah, Mormon territory, where they are tracking people down, getting people healed, and even seeing someone raised from the dead.

I asked him in my office, because I knew what he would answer, "Bronk, this new anointing has really stepped up, has it not?"

He said, "Yes."

I said, "What do you attribute it to?"

He has all the keys, but I asked, "What do you attribute it to?"

The reason I am having him stand up here is because I would to God that I could pull enough out of you and put enough into you to get you into private worship. I am going to feel like I failed if you leave here and do not break through.

So you had better pray to God that he and I will be able to convince you, because if we cannot, you are going to miss another major key to the walk of power.

Bronk said:

"Another notable miracle."

I followed Pastor around that whole week, and when I could interrupt him, I would say, "Sorry, Pastor, can I have your attention? Another notable miracle has taken place."

That went on the whole week. But the thing I told him last night in his office was, "Pastor, those have not stopped. The ones that happened while you were there have not changed. They are still walking. They are still healed."

Personally, I have not been doing anything different other than moving in that worship limb God delivered to Pastor. Because of it, here are two or three things I told him.

There was a woman approximately six weeks ago in a neighboring city. We were called to go minister to her. They said she was in the last stages of lupus. The doctors said they really could not do anything for her because she was so far along they could not even begin to treat her.

She was twenty-nine years old. When I went into the house, the family had gathered and was giving their condolences. Children were running in and out of the house. This twenty-nine-year-old lady was sitting on the couch crying.

It was one of those situations where I thought, If I ever felt like Christ coming into a situation, this was it. I did not have much help, although there was a couple there ministering.

As I sat down in total chaos and began to talk to her, the anointing came on me. I began to explain to her that Satan was doing this and not God. She did not understand that, but once I gave that revelation to her, the Holy Spirit fell in the place.

By the time I was ready to minister and pray for her healing, there was a holy hush in the house. Everybody had stopped. They began to ask, "Can we pray with you?"

As we stood with joined hands, I led them in a sinner's prayer. Then I prayed for the lady. The power of the Holy Spirit fell, and the Holy Spirit said, "I am healing her right now."

I thought, God, I know by faith she is healed, but You are telling me that?

The one thing He said was, "You do not think I would send you all the way over here not to heal her, do you?"

That was a tremendous rebuke. I love it when He does that.

Three days later, I got a call. They said, "We have to tell you this. The doctors said they fouled up the first report. Now they say they can detect that she is only in the beginning stages."

The beginning stages.

I said, "My God, what a reversal."

Just before we came up here, we were called to a lady in our church. She had been coming about six months. She had been in the hospital for two days in excruciating pain. They had her under observation and did not know what to do. The surgeon was coming down. In fact, while we were there, the nurse came in and said, "The surgeon will be down in a little bit."

Basically, they had determined they were going to have to do exploratory surgery.

We laid hands on her. We began with worship, just worship to start with. Then we laid hands on her, and the power of God filled the place. After it was over, I told her, "When he gets here, he is not going to find anything. Besides that, he is going to let you go. There is not going to be any surgery."

That was on a Thursday night. Friday night she was sitting in the back of the church, worshipping the Lord with no pain at all.

We have had interruptions lately. One lady interrupted the service the other night to tell us about a woman we had prayed for several months ago. God had interrupted the service and had us go back and pray for a lady terminally ill with cancer. This woman, who was related to her or knew her, said, "Pastor, I have to tell you, that lady we prayed for has no sign of cancer anymore."

There are so many things now that I cannot keep up with them. Everything from cancer to little things. A lady and her husband mow our church lawn. She stopped us and said, "I am going to the hospital." She had had a hernia for years and said, "I cannot take the pain anymore."

We prayed for her on the spot. That was weeks ago. She stood and testified the other day, "I am totally healed. No more pain from the time you prayed."

We have a lady in our church now doing nothing but writing down all these miracles. After a while I said, "My God, I cannot keep up with them."

God is doing a work, and I praise Him for that worship limb, Pastor. Hallelujah.

I understand the increase in the anointing when I ask him what he attributes it to. Everything else has everything to do with it: the praying-in-tongues limb, the speaking-the-Word limb, the meditation limb. All of it has everything to do with it. The fasting limb is major.

Then there is the worship limb. That has a lot to do with the anointing and the tangible presence that surrounds you, something you can feel with your senses.

To tell you the truth, God tried to get me into that kind of worship a couple of years ago. I passed it up. When I finally broke into it for a couple of weeks, Tim bought me Rick Joyner's book on how God receives worship. That was just before the March conference. I prostrated myself on the floor and wept, because I thanked God I got the book after I broke into worship. I hated to think He had never talked to me about it while that kind of information was available.

For months I went around saying, "I thank God I got the book after I broke into worship."

Finally, up in Washington, God stopped me and said, "No, you would not have."

It hurt me. I said, "I would not have?"

He said, "No. You would have just read the book and gone on like you were."

That is why I had a visitation. I knew I could not go one step further and accomplish what He wanted. I had a visitation because I had prayed myself to that visitation, praying in tongues and fasting. Since you are the preacher bunch, I will tell you: I was on the ninth day of the fast when He visited me. He knocked me down on the floor and started talking to me.

I got up, and since March I have not been the same.

I would to God that we could get this into you: private worship. I thank God for all the worship we do corporately, but it is not enough. It is not enough to bring the change.

So this morning I am going to give you a few verses about the ministry of the Holy Spirit in this limb of worship.

Go to John 16:12. He is pacing me, so that is a safety valve that says I will not be very long. Of course, this afternoon we have until the next morning.

Father, I worship You in spirit and truth. I worship You and love You. You are so faithful. You cannot be anything but faithful. Faithfulness is the fruit of one of Your attributes. You cannot be anything else. You are faithful to us to an end, if You had one. You are utterly faithful. You are always there, doing all that You can do, and I am just learning to receive that.

I worship You, praise You, and glorify You now. We are hungry for what men cannot give us. So teach us. Teach us. As Your children, we are careful to give You all the praise, honor, and glory.

Everybody said, Amen.

There is an order when a person approaches the Godhead, especially if I have a petition in my hands and I am going to petition Him. Each member of the Godhead plays a role in that petition. If I could teach the rest of John here, I could show you the whole role.

The Holy Spirit's designation and ministry is to turn me over to Jesus. It is literally to glorify Him. Many times we say, "I really feel the presence of the Holy Spirit." But He really cannot do anything but glorify Jesus. His whole ministry is to reveal Jesus in you and glorify Him.

When you feel the presence of someone as He is glorifying someone, that is Jesus.

When you approach the Godhead and want to present a petition to your Father, remember that Jesus said the Father loves you. In this covenant, in the day of our sonship, He said the Father loves you and you can ask Him yourself. He will give it to you.

The disciples were used to asking Jesus, and He got everything for them. But He said, "You can ask the Father, and you can ask Him in My name."

When I approach the Father with a petition, it is the Holy Spirit who turns me over to Jesus. Unless I do not have time, and when I petition Him I always make time, because a petition is something you prepare. I go into the presence of Jesus and worship Him under the anointing and instructions of the Holy Spirit until He comes, until I am turned over to Him.

Then, when I am in His presence, I worship Him, and He brings me into the presence of the Father.

I do not like to rush a petition, because I have found out how final my Father is. He is absolutely final. When I present a petition, it is final. That is it. He is done. I will never take it back unless He shows me something was wrong with it. Then I will correct it. But once I present a petition, it is as final to me as eternity.

One of the missing links to faith is our inability, once we turn something over to Him, to walk away and leave it there permanently.

If you can understand the role of the Holy Spirit in glorifying Jesus in the presentation of a petition, then you should know there is a whole area waiting for you. The Holy Spirit is the One who will teach you how to glorify Jesus. He is the One who will teach you how to worship Him. He will magnify Him so strongly that nothing but worship will begin to break out of you for the Father.

He is the One who can bring you in.

John 16:12 says:

"I have yet many things to say unto you, but ye cannot bear them now."

The reason they could not bear them was that their candle had not been lit yet. They were unregenerated, spiritually dead men, and there was only so much they could understand.

Then Jesus said:

"Howbeit when he, the Spirit of truth, is come, he will guide you into all truth: for he shall not speak of himself; but whatsoever he shall hear, that shall he speak: and he will show you things to come.

He shall glorify me: for he shall receive of mine, and shall show it unto you.

All things that the Father hath are mine: therefore said I, that he shall take of mine, and shall show it unto you."

This is His whole ministry.

Again, as in so many camp meetings before, I cannot thank Him enough for the years I carried the praying-in-tongues limb around, looking for a tree it would fit on. Baptists did not want it. Faith people really did not want it. Some of them, not all of them, said we were a bunch of upstarts trying to get the newest revelation. They said, "If you pray in tongues too much, you will get weird."

That is a bald-faced lie.

I have already done that, and I did not get like you are. When somebody says you pray too much in tongues, they are already weird.

Praying in tongues is a revelation gift. Jesus said, "What He hears, that He will speak, and He will glorify Me." That is the way you activate the Teacher on the inside of you on purpose, as much as you want, as often as you want, simply because you want to.

So when I prayed myself to the place where it was time for the worship limb, guess who took charge? The Holy Spirit also took charge of that revelation of Jesus.

I had not been in private worship three days before I heard myself, under the inspiration of the Holy Spirit, saying in English:

"Lord, Father God, Holy Spirit, is it not Your ministry to turn me over to Jesus? Is it not Your ministry to glorify Jesus? Holy Spirit, You have to help me die. You have to, so that I may glorify Him and He might be exalted.

I charge You, Holy Spirit. This is Your ministry. You have to help me die. You do not have any choice if Jesus is to be glorified. You have to help me. Now help me."

Any of you who have crashed the flesh with worship, who have put it down and won over it, can testify that it is not an easy battle to win. Imaginations multiply. Things you hate about yourself are magnified. Sometimes I would come out of six hours of worship feeling like a heathen who wanted to die.

Hallelujah.

At the end of two weeks, I had my first notable baptism of His presence in my senses. It took place right on the line where I fight the battle with the world, where the world is trying to influence what I see, hear, and feel, and my new nature is trying to promote the Word and say that the world does not have the final say.

That baptism took place on that line, and it became the winning edge for anointings and everything else.

I captured it. I had to. There are too many preachers waiting for it. I stayed on my face until I captured it.

Now I have meditated and listened to God for hours, and this is what I captured. I am afraid I cannot do a much better job than to give it to you.

If you are going to pray, pray, "I catch this, and I walk away with it."

I do not care how busy your schedule is. I can boldly tell you that you can carve out enough time to start. Nobody ever caused revival while living in excuses.

This is going to have everything to do with the anointing you walk in.

I was just talking to Dennis, my friend. I had a camp meeting in Phoenix, Arizona, and we had a great time. Somebody else who was there told me that something like seven deaf ears opened, a blind eye opened, and a stiff arm that would not bend was healed. A man who had scales and dried-out skin from chemical burns had something happen to him also.

Worship definitely has something to do with the tangible presence of God that you walk in, that surrounds you, and that fills your meetings. The more you worship and do the other limbs, the more tangible power will come into your geographical existence.

Are you hearing me?

As you know, I wrote to somebody. I keep these things in front of me so I will not get out of balance.

Brother Tim,

Something unusual happened to me several months ago. I am just now beginning to understand the effect it is having on my life.

There was a special prayer line to receive strength for change. In these kinds of lines, it is the grace of God that helps us trade our weaknesses for His strength. When the line was just about over, the Holy Spirit told me to get in. A friend of mine was helping me minister that night, and when I did, a gentle breeze blew past my ears. My spirit seemed to get lighter and lighter.

The next thing I knew, I was lying on the floor, and the Holy Spirit was beginning to speak to me. He said, "You do not know much about worship." Then He instructed me to worship a certain amount of time each day, not because worship can be scheduled in and out like an appointment, but so I could initially break through and understand what He was wanting to teach me.

Because I was on a certain day of a fast, my mind immediately questioned, What about fasting? Do You want me to continue fasting?

God responded, "I did not tell you not to fast. But fasting cannot give you what worship can. Neither can worship give you what fasting does."

My mind protested a little, and God brought me back and reminded me of three revivalists. Two of them, I remember, would fast two or more forty-day fasts a year. As I looked back over their lives and how effective their ministries had been, God helped me understand that when anyone puts all

their confidence in just one key, such as fasting, and believes it is the answer for everything, God will do all He can for them. But unfortunately, there will be other areas of their life He cannot minister to.

As I lay on the floor, I became excited about the prospect of worship the way He was going to teach me. As my mind continued to ponder the different keys He had given me over the years, I could not help but think that if I was guilty of exalting one key as the answer to everything, it would be praying in tongues.

But God comforted me by assuring me that because praying in tongues is a revelation gift, it is something you cannot do too much of. It is the reason He was able to reveal so many other keys that I now understand and hold close to my heart, such as meditation, confession, fasting, and now worship.

So when He said to me, "You do not know much about worship," I made the necessary arrangements to set myself aside a certain amount of time each day to worship and find out what He wanted me to know.

I went into my sound room, where I make radio tapes, closed the door, and began to worship.

Two weeks later, I was experiencing a presence that, until that time, I only knew existed in the realm of possibility. But now I was experiencing firsthand what has to be what so many of us are looking for, though we do not quite know what it is because we have never experienced drinking from the deep well of worship.

Follow me closely, Tim. This could be what you are looking for. It could change your faith forever and change the way you receive from God.

As many times as I have been over the Word of God, it continues to amaze me how much of it I still miss. Just when you think you know everything about a verse, it happens again. Something opens up that changes the way you look at things.

That is what happened to me concerning the Samaritan woman, when Jesus sat on the edge of Jacob's well and began to reveal His heart and the heart of His Father to her in John 4. It changed the way I looked at worship forever.

As I listened to my spirit and went over and over again the encounter He had with her, it was there at Jacob's well that I began to understand what my Father wanted from me: the closeness that you can only have with family.

God is first my Father, and then He is my God. As my God, He has given me everlasting life and secured my future with an abundance as inexhaustible as the limitless power He holds as Creator.

But as my Father, He wants from us the fellowship and closeness that we can only give Him through being born again, climbing up into His arms with a nature like His own, and loving Him with the adoration and worship of a son who believes the sun rises and sets on his father and that there is none other like him.

As Jesus sat on the edge of Jacob's well and talked with the Samaritan woman, I knew He was separating the kind of worship we can have with God the Father from the kind of worship Old Testament saints could have with Him. They could not give Him what they did not have: the worship that comes from the new nature of the born-again human spirit.

Jesus said:

"God is a Spirit: and they that worship him must worship him in spirit and in truth."

John 4:23 says:

"But the hour cometh, and now is, when the true worshipers shall worship the Father in spirit and in truth: for the Father seeketh such to worship him."

When He said, "The hour cometh, and now is," He meant there had never been an hour before this one. Not in the history of man, not since the fall of Adam and the spiritual death of the human race, could anyone ever worship God in spirit and in truth. No one could give Him what He wanted from them: the fellowship and worship that emanate from the new nature.

But you can give Him that because you have been born again.

When He said, "The Father seeketh such to worship him," it did not mean He was hopping from church to church looking for a good worship team. It means God sought and waited out the generations leading up to the cross, patiently working the redemption plan, longing for the day when He could restore the new nature to the human race and have the kind of fellowship with Him He had been waiting for for four thousand years.

That was only made available through the new birth.

And I can give Him what He wants.

It is not that God did not have a relationship with the Old Testament saints. He did. They worshiped Him out of their mind and soul and gave Him as much of themselves as they could. But as much as God loved them, there was only a certain closeness He could have with them because of their sin natures. Even that closeness could only be obtained through animal sacrifice as they worshiped Him through the veil of animal blood.

What God longed for, they could not give: the fellowship and worship that come from being born again and having the same nature He has.

Hebrews 10:4 says:

"For it is not possible that the blood of bulls and of goats should take away sins."

Jesus could not have spoken more highly of anyone under the old covenant than He did of John the Baptist. Matthew 11:11 says:

"Verily I say unto you, Among them that are born of women there hath not risen a greater than John the Baptist: notwithstanding he that is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he."

Of all the Old Testament saints, the prophets, the men of wisdom such as Moses, David, and Solomon, Jesus said there had never been born of woman one greater than John. But He went on to say that the least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he.

Why? Because before Jesus rose from the dead, the new nature was not yet available. The least in the kingdom of heaven would be greater than John because the Old Testament saints had not yet been given the new birth.

How could Jesus say the least in the kingdom of heaven was greater than John if John already belonged to the kingdom of heaven? He did not, because the new nature was not yet available. John, like Nicodemus, had not yet been born again.

But you have.

John could not give the Father what He longed for, the fellowship of the new nature. Neither could Solomon or David. Their fellowship with God stopped just short of the unregenerated human spirit. God could not go there.

But we can, because we have been born again.

If you would like to know more, there are three volumes on the tape table called *The Born-Again Trail I*, *The Born-Again Trail II*, and *The Born-Again Trail III*. They are an in-depth exploration of who you are.

All the Old Testament saints lived under the shadow of things to come. One thing is certain: there cannot be a shadow without something being present to make the shadow.

But once a person is born again, he no longer belongs to the shadow. He has been baptized into whatever is making the shadow, and that is the body of Christ.

When the Judaizers came to the Colossians trying to indoctrinate them into keeping the law, Paul said in Colossians 2:16-17:

"Let no man therefore judge you in meat, or in drink, or in respect of a holy day, or of the new moon, or of the sabbath days:
Which are a shadow of things to come; but the body is of Christ."

I frequently run into believers who keep the Sabbath, not understanding that the Sabbath was a type, a shadow, of something else to come. Once He who makes the shadow has come, it is impossible to live in the shadow and in the thing making the shadow at the same time.

Have you wondered why, under the shadow, under the law, if a man so much as picked up a stick of firewood on the Sabbath day, he was stoned to death?

Numbers 15:32-36 says:

"And while the children of Israel were in the wilderness, they found a man that gathered sticks upon the sabbath day.

And they that found him gathering sticks brought him unto Moses and Aaron, and unto all the congregation.

And they put him in ward, because it was not declared what should be done to him.

And the Lord said unto Moses, The man shall be surely put to death: all the congregation shall stone him with stones without the camp.

And all the congregation brought him without the camp, and stoned him with stones, and he died; as the Lord commanded Moses."

Under the shadow, the Sabbath was a type of the rest you and I would enter into when we were born again and ceased from the burden and weight of our own sins.

If Joshua had been able to give the children of Israel rest when he led them across Jordan into the promised land, Paul would not have spoken of another day in Hebrews 4:8-10:

"For if Joshua had given them rest, then would he not afterward have spoken of another day.

There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God.

For he that is entered into his rest, he also hath ceased from his own works, as God did from his."

Because the Sabbath is a type of the rest you and I enter into when we are born again, the penalty was so stringent even for picking up a piece of firewood because our salvation cannot be earned. Any works whatsoever on the Sabbath, under the shadow, took our salvation out of grace and put it into works, under which it would be impossible to be born again.

Paul said in Ephesians 2:8-9:

"For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God:

Not of works, lest any man should boast."

Men like John the Baptist, King David, and Solomon waited out the generations leading up to the cross in an Old Testament type of heaven, a shadow of heaven itself. It was a comfortable place that Jesus talked about in Luke 16:22 when He said:

"And it came to pass, that the beggar died, and was carried by the angels into Abraham's bosom."

Later Jesus said Lazarus was comforted there. Some waited thousands of years. Before Abraham's bosom, there was the promise of Abraham's bosom. Then Abraham's bosom was the promised shadow of our final deliverance, which was heaven itself. But that had to wait on the rebirth.

It was comfortable waiting out the dispensations leading up to the cross underneath the shadow until Jesus could give them all a new nature and bring them out from underneath the shadow into heaven itself, forever in the presence of God.

All creation waited for the Firstborn from the dead to be born, Jesus Christ.

We know there were several natural resurrections under the Old Testament before Jesus' time. If Colossians were talking about a natural resurrection and not a spiritual one, any one of those could have been first because they all went before Jesus.

The emphasis was not on Jesus' natural resurrection but on His spiritual one. How could He be called the Firstborn from the dead if there had been anyone before Him? There was not, not even Adam. After the spiritual death of the human race, all had to wait for the Firstborn to be born so they could follow Him out of spiritual death.

Colossians 1:18 says:

"And he is the head of the body, the church: who is the beginning, the firstborn from the dead; that in all things he might have the preeminence."

When God said to me, "You do not know much about worship," what He wanted me to understand was the difference between Old and New Testament worship. Out of our new nature, there is a communion through worship that flows from our spirit to God's Spirit and is sin-free.

God is a Spirit. He seeks such to worship Him and longs for this kind of fellowship with His children.

You might as well know that your personal worship in heaven will be spontaneous. Surrounded by the glories of heaven, you will not be able to contain yourself. Multiply hundreds of thousands of times the feelings you have here when you love someone so much that you want to bring them joy and your greatest joy is to bring them happiness.

When the Father smiles at you in heaven, Tim, you will feel like you found your greatest purpose in life. Floods of joy will make you certain that you are the highest achiever who has ever lived, and pleasing Him is the most fulfilling thing you have ever done. Deep-seated feelings of joy will escape us, erupting frequently in worship as the Father's joy sweeps over us. We will know we have found everything, with eternity ahead of us and none of it ever going to end. It will only get better.

But we do not have to wait until we get to heaven to thank Him. The Father lives in great expectation that you will begin to fellowship with Him now.

Who cannot worship Him in heaven? Who cannot, when it is spontaneous and waves of glory cause you to erupt in worship on the spot? Who can help it?

But you can bring Him the same thing now. There is no distance between us and Him. What separated us from Him could not be measured by standards of distance, but by spiritual death. Now we have been put back into His presence and can worship Him and fellowship with Him as though we were in heaven itself, made possible through the new nature.

God tried to get me into extended worship a year and a half before this time. I only wish I had listened. Had I known what worship would do to my faith, much less my ability to receive from God, I would have surrendered long ago to even the smallest promptings. It would not have taken the light rebuke I received in the prayer line that night.

Hear what I am saying, Tim. Take it from an old warhorse who has been around for a while. This could be what you are looking for.

I was on my way back from a passion play when He first tried to get me into this. Everything was perfect: the costumes, the acting, the music. Nothing was out of place, not one note of music, not one prop. Hell was hot. Angels flew.

There was just one problem: no anointing.

As I rode along, wondering why and what it would take to fill a passion play like that with God's presence, God took advantage of the situation to teach me. I had one of those kinds of visions that materializes in your spirit with the understanding of a thousand words.

I saw a small rock landing in a pond. The ripples that emanated from the stone filled the whole pond.

He said to me:

"The more you worship, the more the Holy Spirit will be able to permeate your spirit with presence. The ripples from your spirit will permeate your soul, and the ripples from your soul will permeate your senses, until His presence not only surrounds your whole being, but will permeate the atmosphere around you until even other people are aware of His presence."

Can you imagine what this could do to a worship leader's anointing? Or to the message of a preacher? Or to the home of a believer? What about the unbelief that fights all of us? Your emotions could just as easily be charged with His presence as they are with torment and fear.

Your call.

When I locked myself in my sound room, I had no other motive than to worship God. I was not asking for anything and was not trying to receive anything, so I was not entirely prepared for what was about to happen.

At first it was easy. Then the time I had committed to worship began to stretch itself out until even minutes took their time passing by. At times I felt as dry as cracker juice and my flesh as cold as a side of beef in a meat locker.

But I kept going.

Please listen to me. Do not ever listen to teachings that say, because you do not feel His presence when you worship, He is not there, He is not coming, or you are doing something wrong. That dry process you go through is nothing more than change. What makes you think that just because you do not feel Him, He is not receiving the worship?

Why you do or do not "break through" has nothing to do with whether He is receiving the worship. In fact, some of the times when you feel it the least, you are breaking through the most because you are dealing with things that kept you from it before.

God is looking for a few good men and women.

Hallelujah.

I kept worshipping:

"I love You. I love You. Hallelujah. I said I love You. I mean I really love You. I love You."

Some kind of baptism of my senses began to take place as His presence came and lingered with me while I went about my day. This presence seemed to want to fellowship with my decisions and with my prayers. As I prayed for people, He was there before I was. He seemed to want to fill my faith with the presence that has to be the substance of things hoped for, because long-standing answers to prayer began to come in.

Hebrews 11:1 says:

"Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen."

I should have known that worship had something to do with receiving from God.

God put me into extended amounts of time to teach me because I am a teacher and He knew I would do it. But to teach you in this letter everything He has for you concerning worship would be impossible. There would have to be a book.

You and I are going to explore incredible things in God. Right now I can tell you this: even short amounts of time giving yourself completely to worship, maybe a half hour to an hour each day, will be enough to start. In that short time, offer your whole self, pouring everything you are into short statements of adoration, magnifying and glorifying Him, giving Him all the praise, honor, and glory.

Tim, He loves it when you continually say things like:

"I love You, Father God. I love You. I adore You, and I want You more than life."

He loves it, Tim. You have enough faith to do this, and you are going to be surprised what God will do for you. It is not how good you make statements about God sound, as though you are trying to structure worship into great theological speeches. It is the amount of heart and soul you pour into each statement of adoration.

Look at Ephesians 5:17-20:

"Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.
And be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit;
Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord;
Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."

Notice that when Paul said, "Speaking to yourselves in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs," he was talking about private worship.

When I went before God to worship Him, I had no other motive but to love Him and give Him glory. But you cannot go before God to worship Him without it having a profound effect on your senses. I came to call this the baptism of my senses in His presence.

Verse 18 says, "Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit." What part of a person is affected by too much alcohol? Is it not the senses? Yet somehow Paul compared that to being filled with the Spirit.

Why does an alcoholic drink? Some never sober up; in fact, if you saw them sober, you would not know them. They sedate their senses with alcohol so the reality of life never has to settle in.

But we belong to a spiritual kingdom, yet God had to leave us in a physical body with our senses continually in contact with a negative world that we have to deal with every day.

The same way an alcoholic deals with life by numbing his senses to it, you and I can be filled with the Spirit by speaking to ourselves in private worship, in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs. That worship will have a similar effect on your senses as alcohol has on the alcoholic's senses, only he is running from his responsibilities and you are running into yours.

Let me make this plain: he is running from his responsibilities; you and I are running toward ours.

The presence of alcohol moving on his mind moves him out of responsibility and into irresponsibility. The presence of the Holy Spirit moving on our mind moves us out of the world's irresponsibility and into God's responsibility.

The presence of God moving on your senses sedates you against the negative input of the world that is against the promises of God. It manifests as presence and peace that says, "The operation of God's kingdom is more real and alive to me than the operation of this world."

Let us cancel this afternoon and worship God.

In my time of private worship, I not only spend time telling my Father how much I love Him, not asking for anything, just loving Him. I also spend time thanking Him and praising Him for all He has done for me and provided, as Ephesians 5:20 says:

"Giving thanks always for all things unto God and the Father in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ."

Remember, Jesus will become to you what you call Him the most. You cannot worship God for an hour and call Jesus your Healer, your Provider, your Peace, or your Wisdom without Him becoming to you those things you call Him.

It has been my pleasure.

Your friend.

Oh, glory to God. Hallelujah.

I thank God for our team, our staff, and our people here. Anything spiritual that I want to do, they are right there. They will move everything. If I fail in this life and this ministry, it will not be because I did not have every opportunity to succeed.

It was not always like that.

I used to put in ten to twelve hours first, pick people up, drive two hours to the meeting, then go fellowship until two in the morning because a preacher would talk to me. Then I would go home and repeat the same thing the next day as long as the revival went on.

It was not always like it is now.

The day all my time was my own, I thought I had died and gone to heaven, because I was getting to do what I had longed to do.

I remember the first three months, I got \$700 in debt. Today that would be like \$3,000. I made that stand in faith and prayed in tongues every day for three months. One day, a man walked up and handed me enough money to pay all my bills, give \$100 away, and still have \$100 left over.

The day I got that check, I waited until the bank opened the next day. I went and said, "When I put this in, can I just write checks on it?"

They said, "Yes."

I went down and paid the food bill we had charged. As I walked down the street, the sun was brighter, the birds sang, and butterflies flew around my head.

When I got done paying everything, I went back to my closet. I had been praying in tongues, not knowing what it would do. I got down, looked at the money I had left over, and started worshipping God.

Then I said, "Wait a minute. I get to get out of bed, and all day long now I get to do what I had longed to do? I get to meditate and pray, and then go out and tell other people what You told me, and You are going to pay me for it? What is this, heaven?"

Preachers give up so easily.

God is not going to give you that time when you are throwing away the time you have now. You talk about full-time ministry, you lazy thing. You are fooling yourself when you are serving in full capacity with your job. That is when He will send you.

You think you can sit around, cry, and bawl about your needs not being met because you are called full-time? Get the hint: nobody wants you.

You run out of meetings? There are things to do. Serve. Your day will come.

I not only built the furniture for the little Sunday school classes; I taught them. I not only taught them; I picked them up. We would run our red station wagon thirty miles away to the pines, pick up a group of them, and run them all over. If the church needed painting, I was there to paint. I was there to do everything.

Now He has given me my time, all that I want.

You do not have to have the time I did. Listen to me. Be convinced. Take it from somebody who has already been there. Be the sower that overtakes the harvester. Make dust. Let me see your dust.

Come on. Do what I did in seven years, not twenty-six.

Make dust. Make me happy.

Let us stand up and worship God for a minute.